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Zion Clark



Athlete born without legs: wrestler, pro MMA fighter, three-time Guinness World Records holder and subject of the Emmy-winning Netflix film ZION.

From Columbus, Ohio · Keynotes for companies, sales teams, schools and athletes; brand partnerships and appearances

#KeynoteSpeaker #NoExcuses #BeGreaterThan #Resilience #Wrestling #MMA #GuinnessWorldRecords #AdaptiveAthlete

No Excuses mindset | Be Greater Than your obstacles | Overcoming adversity | Discipline and daily training | Growing up in foster care | Performance under pressure | Working with what you've got

At a glance

Zion Clark was born without legs due to caudal regression syndrome and grew up in Ohio's foster care system before being adopted. He went winless for years on the wrestling mat, then finished his senior season at Massillon Washington High School 33–15, one match from the state championships. Since then he has set three Guinness World Records, won his professional MMA debut and starred in ZION, the Sundance-selected Netflix documentary that won two Sports Emmys. On stage he teaches his No Excuses, Be Greater Than mindset to companies, students, athletes and nonprofit leaders.

3 records
Guinness World Records, including fastest 20 m on hands (4.78 s)

2 Emmys
ZION, his Netflix documentary, at the 40th Sports Emmys

Sundance
ZION was an official selection in 2018

1–0
Pro MMA record, debut win by unanimous decision (2022)

AGT
Semifinalist on America's Got Talent, Season 18 (2023)

2 books
Zion Unmatched (2021) and Work with What You Got (2023)

As seen in **Guinness World Records · CNN**

Brands, stages & platforms Zion has worked with

Netflix · Guinness World Records · America's Got Talent · HBO · F45 · Promix · ZYN · Legends · Sundance Film Festival · Gladiator Challenge

Keynotes & assemblies

No Excuses

The mindset that took him from winless seasons to a 33–15 senior year, Guinness World Records and pro MMA.

Keynote

Be Greater Than

Practical steps and a toolbox for achieving what looks impossible, for teams facing change and pressure.

Keynote for companies and sales teams

Work with What You Got

From foster care to the national stage, on resilience, identity and making the most of what you have.

Keynote or school assembly

Train Like a Champion

Discipline, repetition and goal-setting from an elite wrestler and fighter, for athletes and student-athletes.

Keynote or workshop

Who it's for

- Fortune 500 companies
- startups
- sales teams
- athletes
- college students
- schools and youth programs
- nonprofit leaders

About Zion

Zion Clark was born on September 29, 1997, in Columbus, Ohio, without legs due to caudal regression syndrome. Given up at birth, he grew up moving between foster homes before being adopted. He found wrestling, and music as his church's lead drummer, at a young age, then went several seasons without a win. Under coach Gil Donahue at Massillon Washington High School he finished his senior year 33–15, losing 1–0 in sudden death one match short of the Ohio state championships, and won a state wheelchair racing title. He went on to wrestle and race at Kent State University's Tuscarawas campus. His story became ZION, a 2018 Sundance selection on Netflix that won two Sports Emmys. He holds three Guinness World Records, won his professional MMA debut in December 2022, reached the semifinals of America's Got Talent in 2023 and has written two books with journalist James S. Hirsch.

Track record

- Three Guinness World Records: fastest 20 m walking on hands (4.78 s), highest box jump with the hands (0.83 m) and most diamond push-ups in three minutes (248)
- Subject of ZION (2018): official selection at the Sundance Film Festival, streaming on Netflix, winner of two Sports Emmys at the 40th Sports Emmy Awards
- Professional MMA debut win by unanimous decision over Eugene Murray, Gladiator Challenge, December 17, 2022 (record 1–0)
- America's Got Talent Season 18 (2023): four yeses, semifinalist
- Featured on HBO's Real Sports with Bryant Gumbel (May 2023)
- Massillon Washington High School wrestling: 33–15 senior season after years without a win; lost 1–0 in sudden death one match from the Ohio state championships
- State high school wheelchair racing title
- Wrestled and raced wheelchair at Kent State University (Tuscarawas)
- Co-author with James S. Hirsch of Zion Unmatched (2021) and the memoir Work with What You Got (2023)
- Speaker at the F45 World Conference
- Featured in or by Forbes, CNN, HBO, Ellen, America's Got Talent and Guinness World Records

Stages & competitions

- F45 World Conference: speaker
- America's Got Talent, Season 18 (2023): semifinalist
- Gladiator Challenge: Seasons Beatings, Valley Center, California (Dec 2022): pro MMA debut win
- Sundance Film Festival (2018): ZION premiere

What people say

> “An inspiration to everyone who meets him.” — Ellen DeGeneres

Press, interviews & podcasts

Guinness World Records
Hall of Fame

CNN
Zion Clark on wrestling, MMA and the Olympics (Dec 2023)

Watch

ZION, the documentary, on Netflix

Books

Work with What You Got
his memoir with James S. Hirsch (2023)

Film

ZION

Zion Unmatched
a photo essay of his journey for ages 8–12, with James S. Hirsch (2021)

the Netflix documentary about his wrestling journey, two Sports Emmys

How we can work together

Looking for

- Paid keynotes, sales kickoffs and school assemblies
- Brand ambassador and sponsorship deals in fitness, nutrition and apparel
- Appearances and content partnerships

Can offer

- A No Excuses keynote with a practical toolbox
- Social content and appearances for brands
- Clinics and demos for athletes and students

Find Zion online

Website | LinkedIn | Instagram | TikTok | YouTube | Media

Book Zion

Booking is handled by V Formation Consulting. Contact the agent for availability, format and fees.

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Sources

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Profile prepared by V Formation Consulting.